

★ Binary Searching:

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[2 | 4 | 6 | 8 | 10 | 12 | 14]

0 1 2 3 4 5 6

→ We are given by an array of integers which can be sorted in either ascending or descending order.

→ we are given by a target element or value, we need to find whether exists in array or not!

→ this can be done by pointing 3 indexes of that array.

① we need to find the start of the array & point it using 'start' variable.

② we need to find its end & point it through 'end' variable.

③ we need to calculate the mid point of the array, its done by adding the start & end index & divide by '2' & store it in mid variable.

suppose, here in the given array,

• start = 0, end = arr.length - 1 (i.e. 6)
target = 12,

You can find the middle element or index simply by using the following formula:

$$\text{start} + \text{end} / 2$$

→ but it can be problematic when you are dealing with too big arrays as:

(start + end) can lead to the exceeding of an integer limit.

→ E.g. integer in Java has a range (a limit of integer) is:
 $(-2^{31} \text{ to } 2^{31} - 1)$

or you can simply say as:

-2,147,483,648 to 2,147,483,647

→ suppose in our binary search, our middle element at current index is 2,999,999,999 & the target value is bigger than value at that index we need to move our start by +1

→ so, start becomes = 2,000,000,000
 (suppose:) our end is = 2,100,000,000

→ if we are using $(\text{start} + \text{end}) / 2$, the $(\text{start} + \text{end})$ exceeds the 'int' limits.

→ but if we do this:

$\text{start} + (\text{end} - \text{start}) / 2$ will not exceed!

$$2,000,000,000 + (2,100,000,000 - 2,000,000,000) / 2$$

$$2,000,000,000 + (100,000,000) / 2$$

$$2,000,000,000 + 50,000,000$$

$$[2,050,000,000] < \text{Integer.MAX-VALUE}$$

that's why we have this optimized formula if we need to use it in program: $\text{start} + (\text{end} - \text{start}) / 2$

suppose,

$\text{start} \rightarrow s$

$\text{end} \rightarrow e$

$$s + \frac{e - s}{2}$$

↓

$$\frac{s + e - s}{2}$$

↓

$$\left(\frac{s + e}{2} \right) \text{ "same"}$$

same

Now comes again to binary search.

We have to run a loop until the ~~start~~ starting index is not exceeding the ending index, i.e. $(\text{start} \leq \text{end})$

because sometimes the case becomes where the target value will be found when the $\text{start} = \text{end} = \text{mid}$

suppose, array:

2	4	6	7	9	11
0	1	2	3	4	5

- $\text{start} = 0$, $\text{end} = n - 1$ (5), $\text{target} = 7$
- on first iteration:

$$\text{mid} = \text{start} + (\text{end} - \text{start}) / 2$$

$$= 0 + 5 / 2 \rightarrow \boxed{2}$$

on $\text{arr}[2] = 6$ is $\boxed{2, 7}$:

$\text{start} = \text{mid} + 1 \rightarrow \text{start} = 3, \text{end} = 5$

• on Second Iteration :

$$\text{start} = 3 < \text{end} = 5$$

$$\begin{aligned} \therefore \text{mid} &= \text{start} + (\text{end} - \text{start}) / 2 \\ &= 3 + (5 - 3) / 2 \\ &= 3 + 2 / 2 \Rightarrow 1 \\ &= 3 + 1 \Rightarrow \boxed{4} \end{aligned}$$

$$\therefore \text{mid} = 4.$$

$$\text{arr}[4] = 9 > 7$$

$$\begin{aligned} \therefore \text{start} &= 3, \text{end} = \text{mid} - 1 \\ &= 4 - 1 \\ &= 3 \end{aligned}$$

• on Third Iteration :

$$\text{start} = 3 = \text{end} = 3$$

$$\begin{aligned} \therefore \text{mid} &= \text{start} + (\text{end} - \text{start}) / 2 \\ &= 3 + (3 - 3) / 2 \\ &= 3 + 0 \\ \therefore \text{mid} &= 3 \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{arr}[3] = 7$$

$$\& \text{arr}[3] = 7 \text{ target}$$

$\therefore$ We got our target on index '3'